The Data team gets data into the data warehouse from a few different places —for example, cost statements from the Hitchcock Movie Maker and subscriptions from the subscriptions service. The team also gets streaming data and subscription profiles from the data lake.

Then the Data team does some number crunching to transform this data into information for fraud analysis and business decisions.

Finally, this information is used by decentralized units to make those business decisions and for other use cases. This currently is a centralized workflow. The data team “sits in the middle.”

No matter where you’re coming from and where you want to go, you will find yourself somewhere along the Messflix journey. So let’s take one final look at the complete journey Messflix is going through.

No data journey is a simple straight line. Likewise, we don’t pretend that the Messflix journey is a simple linear progression of a series of steps. You’ll see different approaches in the chapters and ways to make the data mesh fit your company, even though the Messflix example illustrates one main thread to guide you.

You can follow that main thread used by Messflix throughout chapters 2 through 6 and chapter 9. Table 1 gives you an overview of the stages of the company, as we highlight two dimensions alongside the journey to a data mesh. The first is the number of organizational units and teams affected. The second is the types of company responsibilities that are decentralized.

The core of the data mesh paradigm shift is the decentralization of the responsibility for data. But *responsibility for data* today is practically split into multiple parts, all of which need to be decentralized. Thus we highlight all four kinds of responsibility for data in table 1; each corresponds to one of the principles presented in part 2.

Table 1 The Messflix journey

			Chapter 6	Chapter 7	Chapter 8